

Grade 2 Grammar Master Manual

CHAPTER 1: FOUNDATIONS

"Grammar is the structural foundation of our ability to express ourselves. The more we are aware of how it works, the more we can monitor the meaning and effectiveness of the way we and others use language."

— Charles Darling

What is Grammar in Grade 2?

For our Grade 2 EFL learners, grammar is not about memorizing dry rules or learning linguistic jargon; it is about cracking the code of the English language. Grammar is the toolbox they use to build meaning. When a student understands possessive nouns or compound sentences, they aren't just passing a test—they are gaining the power to expand their writing in their Writing Project Workbooks and comprehend complex sentences in their *myBook* stories.

The "Teach First, Book Second" Philosophy

The *HMH Grammar Practice Book* and the *ELA Course Pack* are fantastic tools for teaching and assessing, but they are **not** your only tools, and they should never be your starting point. You must introduce the target grammar pattern to the whole class in your own dynamic way *before* anyone opens a book. Furthermore, **you should never simply display the workbook answers on the smartboard for students to copy.** Copying is not learning; it is tracing.

WHY

If you start a lesson by telling students to open their workbooks, it instantly becomes a chore. Grammar must be brought to life first. The workbook is a space for them to apply what you have just taught them.

Simple & Effective Whole-Class Introductions

Before touching the workbook, spend 10–15 minutes bringing the grammar concept to life. Here are a few highly effective, low-prep strategies for Grade 2:

- **Human Sentences:** Give 5-6 students a whiteboard or a piece of paper with one word on it. Have them stand at the front of the class. Ask the seated students to direct the "human words" to physically move around to form a correct sentence.
- **"Fix-the-Teacher's-Mistake":** Second graders love correcting adults. Write a sentence on the board that breaks the grammar rule you are teaching (e.g., *monday is my favorite day.*). Let them play detective to figure out what you did wrong and why it needs to be fixed.
- **Color-Coding:** Assign colors to parts of speech (e.g., Nouns are Blue, Verbs are Red). Write a sentence on the smartboard and have students come up and circle the target grammar pattern in the correct color.

Scaffolding for the EFL Learner

Because our students are learning English as a foreign language, grammar can feel incredibly abstract. To help them succeed, we use a teaching strategy called **scaffolding**.

- **Providing Word Banks:** Instead of asking them to think of a proper noun from scratch, give them a list of 5 words and ask them to choose the proper noun.
- **Sentence Frames:** Providing the structure with blanks (e.g., "*The _____ (dog) bone is buried.*" -> "*The dog's bone is buried.*").
- **Visual Cues:** Using a physical gesture (like making a big "C" with your arms for a Capital Letter) every time you talk about Proper Nouns.

Differentiating Expectations

A- GROUP

Focus: Application and independent work.

Strategy: These students will grasp the mechanical rules quickly. Your goal is to push them to the "Why." Ask them to generate their own examples from scratch. Once the whole-class lesson is done, A-Group students should be highly capable of tackling the workbook pages independently.

I- GROUP

Focus: Structure, identification, and confidence-building.

Strategy: These students require heavy, consistent scaffolding. Do not expect them to complete workbook pages entirely on their own immediately.

TIP

For I-Group, read the workbook instructions aloud, do the first two questions together on the board to model the exact expectation, and leave your color-coded examples on the smartboard while they work.

CHAPTER 2: CURRICULUM & MATERIALS

"A craftsman is only as good as his tools, but it is the teacher's hands that build the understanding."

The Core Texts

- **The ELA Course Pack (Grammar Study Pages):** This is the reference guide. It contains the visual anchor charts and explicit rules. Use this as your "textbook" during the guided portion of your lesson.
- **The HMH Grammar Practice Book:** This is the application zone. It provides the targeted exercises for the weekly objectives. It is a workbook for *practice*, not the primary tool for *teaching*.

The "I Do, We Do, You Do" Approach

To transition students from your dynamic whole-class introduction into the workbook, you must use the Gradual Release of Responsibility model.

1. I Do (Direct Instruction & Modeling):

Explicitly teach the rule. Model your thought process out loud. *"I see the word 'taiwan'. I know Taiwan is the name of a specific place, making it a proper noun. Proper nouns need capital letters, so I am going to erase the small 't' and write a big 'T'."*

2. We Do (Guided Practice):

Read the instructions aloud. Do the first two or three questions together as a class. Call on students to come to the smartboard or share their answers.

3. You Do (Independent Practice):

Students complete the remainder of the in-class workbook pages on their own. Move around the room and challenge them.

Bridging to Writing (WR)

Grammar does not exist in a vacuum. It is the invisible skeleton of the Writing Block (WR). The Grade 2 WR focus is on forming complete sentences, expanding sentences, and building paragraphs.

- **Make the Connection Explicit:** When teaching a WR lesson (like Story Retelling or Personal Narratives), explicitly reference the week's grammar target.
- **The Grammar Requirement:** Require students to use the current grammar skill in their writing drafts.

CHAPTER 3: SCHEDULING & LOGISTICS

"By failing to prepare, you are preparing to fail."

— Benjamin Franklin

Finding the Time: The 80-Minute RS Block

Grammar does not require a dedicated 80-minute block. Instead, it is best taught in focused, high-energy 40-minute increments, leaving the other half of the block for reading or spelling.

THE GOLDEN RULE OF INTEGRATION

Never try to teach a new grammar concept on the same day you are introducing a new spelling list or starting a brand-new *myBook* story. Cognitive overload will cause the students to crash. Slot your Grammar instruction into the "second half" of the week.

CHAPTER 4: PRACTICE & ACCOUNTABILITY

"Practice isn't the thing you do once you're good. It's the thing you do that makes you good."

—Malcolm Gladwell

The 5-Page Split: In-Class vs. Homework

THE GOLDEN RATIO (3 IN-CLASS / 2 HOMEWORK)

- **Pages 1 & 2:** Complete these during the **"We Do"** guided practice phase.
- **Page 3:** This is the **"You Do"** in-class independent practice.
- **Pages 4 & 5:** These are strictly reserved for **Homework**.

Correction Routines: Learning from Mistakes

A red "X" on a workbook page does not teach a student anything. If a student makes a mechanical error, they must be held accountable for fixing it. Circle the error. Return the workbook to the student and require them to fix the circled errors.

The Parent Connection

Require a parent signature at the bottom of Page 5 every week. Remind parents during parent-teacher conferences that grammar homework is about *practice*, not *perfection*.